

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 8 7
♥ T 7 6 4 2
♦ A 6 4 3
♣ 7

♠ A J 5

♥ K Q

♦ Q J 8

♣ T 9 8 5 3



♠ K Q T 4 2

♥ 9 8 5

♦ T 9 7

♣ A 4

♠ 6 3

♥ A J 3

♦ K 5 2

♣ K Q J 6 2

West	North	East	South
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	1 ♣	1 ♠	3 ♣
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Pass	3NT		
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All Pass

3NT by North
while you still have the ♣A for an entry.

[showcards W:SK E:S7 S:S5]

You are East. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♠K, West played the ♠7 and North the ♠5.

What do you play to the second trick?

Play the ♦10, NOT another ♠.

You can see the ♠6, ♠5, ♠4, ♠3 and ♠2. So the ♠7 is West's lowest ♠, he is doing his best to discourage you from leading the suit again.

North held up with ♠A J x, hoping you would play the suit again and give him two tricks.

If you play the ♦10 West will win the ♦A and return a ♠, allowing you to drive out North's ♠A

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 6 3
 ♥ A J 3
 ♦ K 5 2
 ♣ K Q J 6 2

♠ J 7 5
 ♥ T 7 6 4 2
 ♦ A 6 4 3
 ♣ 7



♠ A 9 8
 ♥ K Q
 ♦ Q J 8
 ♣ T 9 8 5 3

♠ K Q T 4 2
 ♥ 9 8 5
 ♦ T 9 7
 ♣ A 4

West	North	East	South
3♣	Pass	1♣	1♠
All Pass		3NT	
3NT by East			

[showcards W:SK E:S7 S:S8]

You are South. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♠K, North played the ♠7 and East the ♠8.

What do you play to the second trick?

Play the ♠4.

You cannot see the ♠5. The most likely reason is that North has it, and his ♠7 is an encouraging signal. The only reason he would encourage you is if he held either the ♠A or ♠J.

Together, you two continue to play ♠s to drive out East's ♠A. When you get the lead with your ♣A you will cash your ♠ winners and North will still have the ♦A for some icing on the cake.

There IS another possibility if East is a better than average Declarer. North just might hold ♠ 9 7, giving East ♠ A J 8 5. East played the ♠8 as a falsecard to tempt you into playing the suit again. This isn't too likely, but if it happens just congratulate East for the fine play.

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 5 4
 ♥ 6 4
 ♦ J 7 3
 ♣ A K Q 6 5 3

♠ A T 7 2

♥ K J 8 3

♦ Q 8 6

♣ J 4



♠ K 8 6 3

♥ Q T

♦ T 9 5 4 2

♣ 8 2

♠ Q J 9

♥ A 9 7 5 2

♦ A K

♣ T 9 7

West

North

East

South

2♣

3♣

Pass

1♥

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by South

[showcards W:CA]

You are East. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♣A, dummy played the ♣4

Play the ♣8 to encourage a continuation. West will play the ♣Q on which you will play the ♣2.

West now knows you started with a doubleton, and more importantly, he also knows you want him to play a third ♣.

When he next plays the ♣K dummy will ruff, but whatever card he ruffs with you will have established a trump trick. When you later win your ♠K that will be down 1.

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A K 5
 ♥ A K Q 5
 ♦ A T 6
 ♣ Q T 3

♠ 7 3

♥ J 8 4 3

♦ K J 9 5 2

♣ 8 2



♠ J 8 4

♥ 7 6 2

♦ 8 4

♣ K J 9 6 5

♠ Q T 9 6 2

♥ T 9

♦ Q 7 3

♣ A 7 4

West	North	East	South
2♣	Pass	2♦	Pass
2NT	Pass	3NT	
All Pass			
3NT by West			

[showcards W:D5 E:DQ,D7,D3 S:D6,DT,DA,CQ]

You are North. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♦5, South wins the ♦Q and returns the ♦7. West holds up his ♦A until the third round. He then plays the ♣Q

Play the ♣8.

You assume (hope) that South holds the ♣A. If he does then he will need help from you to decide which trick he should win. You play the ♣8 first, and the ♣2 next to show an even number.

If South is paying attention he will know to win the THIRD ♣. This will kill dummy's ♣ suit, and with it West's chance of making 9 tricks.

Board 5

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q T 8 4

♥ Q J 9

♦ K 9 5 2

♣ 9 3

♠ K 9 3

♥ A 7 6 5 4

♦ J 8

♣ Q 7 4



♠ J 7 6 5 2

♥ 3

♦ T 6 4

♣ A K T 5

♠ A

♥ K T 8 2

♦ A Q 7 3

♣ J 8 6 2

West

North

East

South

Pass

1 ♥

Pass

1 ♦

Pass

4 ♥

All Pass

4 ♥ by North

[showcards W:CA]

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♣A, dummy played the ♣2

Play the ♣3.

If you signal with the ♣9 East will continue with the ♣K and another which you will have to ruff. You will give up your NATURAL trump trick by doing so. Worse, you will allow South's ♣J to be established as a winner that North can later discard a ♦ on.

Much better to play low. Partner will surely switch to a ♦, and North will probably finesse, though it doesn't matter whether he does or not. You will win the ♦K, return the ♣9 back to East's ♣K, and still have your trump trick for later.

Board 6

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ J 6 4 2

♥ J 6 3

♦ A J 6

♣ T 7 3

♠ 9 3

♥ 5 4

♦ Q T 8 3

♣ J 9 6 5 2



♠ 8 5

♥ A K Q 8 7 2

♦ K 5 4

♣ A Q

♠ A K Q T 7

♥ T 9

♦ 9 7 2

♣ K 8 4

West

North

East

South

2♥

Pass

4♥

1♠

All Pass

4♥ by East

you stop the establishment of West's ♠J. As you can see, East would have been able to discard a loser on that ♠J if you hadn't played this way.

[showcards W:SA E:S9,S3 S:S5,S8]

You are South. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♠A, North plays the ♠9, East the ♠5. You assume North has signaled you to continue ♠s, so you play the ♠Q. On this trick North plays the ♠3 and East the ♠8. How will you continue?

You know that both North and East are now void of ♠s. You might just switch suits, but you have a better choice.

If you play your ♠Q, North won't bother ruffing, East **WILL** ruff and dummy's ♠J will be established as a winner.

The best procedure is to lead a low ♠. North will ruff and East will over-ruff but by playing this way